



PENNSYLVANIA AVENUE GRADE SEPARATION PROJECT

Project Update and Recommendation

Robert Vestal, City Engineer | Director of Public Works

Aaron Hake, Executive Director

Project Purpose

- Lower roadway below railroad
 - Eliminates vehicle delays
 - Improves emergency response
 - Provides safe pedestrian access



Image is a conceptual rendering

Trade Corridor Enhancement Program (TCEP)

- \$49.4 Million TCEP, 2024 Cycle
- Ready to List (RTL) by June 2027
- RTL signifies that the Project has completed major preconstruction requirements



Current Project Funding Summary

Funding or Grant Program	Funding Committed
Trade Corridor Enhancement Program (TCEP)	\$49,400,000
Surface Transportation Block Grant (STBG)	\$7,225,000
Community Project Funding / Congressionally Directed Spending	\$2,000,000
Senate Bill 125 Grant	\$5,000,000
Union Pacific Railroad Contribution (UPRR)	\$3,150,000
Regional Transportation Improvement Program Funds (RTIP)	\$6,698,000
Rail & Bridge Developer Impact Fees (DIF)	\$12,548,093
General Fund	\$5,820,000



Additional Grant Opportunities

Grant Program	Funding Requested	Anticipated Results Date
Railroad Crossing Elimination (RCE)	\$45,464,244	January, 2027
Consolidated Rail Infrastructure and Safety Improvements (CRISI)	\$54,758,907	December, 2026
INFRA Grant Program	\$54,758,907	February, 2027

Recap

- July, 2022 – IDC Authorized to begin Final Design
- December, 2025 – RCTC Agrees to Implement Project
- January, 2026 – HDR Authorized to complete Design



RCTC: Implementing Agency

- Aaron Hake, Executive Director

Supported by:

- Erik Galloway, Project Delivery Director
- Jillian Guizado, Planning & Programming Director

Status

✓ Environmental – NEPA/CEQA CE November 2025

☐ Design

- ~65% complete
- Advancing to 95% in September 2026
- 100% in January 2027
- Railroad coordination

☐ Right of Way

- 65% complete – early acquisitions underway
- Utility relocation coordination

Challenges

- Utility Conflicts and Caltrans Access
 - Need to underground overhead utilities
 - Finding alternative maintenance access
- Union Pacific Railroad
 - Construction & Maintenance agreement

Challenges (continued)

- Master Drainage Plan (MDP) Line 2
 - Project development and delivery
- Cost Increases and Funding Deadlines
 - 73%[↑]
 - June 2027

RCTC Work Continues

- Complete 100% design
- Continue Railroad and Caltrans coordination
- Advance right-of-way acquisitions and utility relocations



City Work Continues

- Finalize MDP Line 2 delivery approach
- Resolve sequencing of construction schedule and phasing with Pennsylvania Grade Separation Project.

Recommendation

- Withdraw 2024 TCEP award
- Apply for 2026 TCEP funding

BONUS SLIDES

Utility Conflicts

- SCE (Edison) relocation
 - Underground vs. overhead
- Verizon/MCI relocation
- Frontier and AT&T
 - Potential conflict with sewer on 6th Street
- Sewer and water line relocation

Caltrans Access

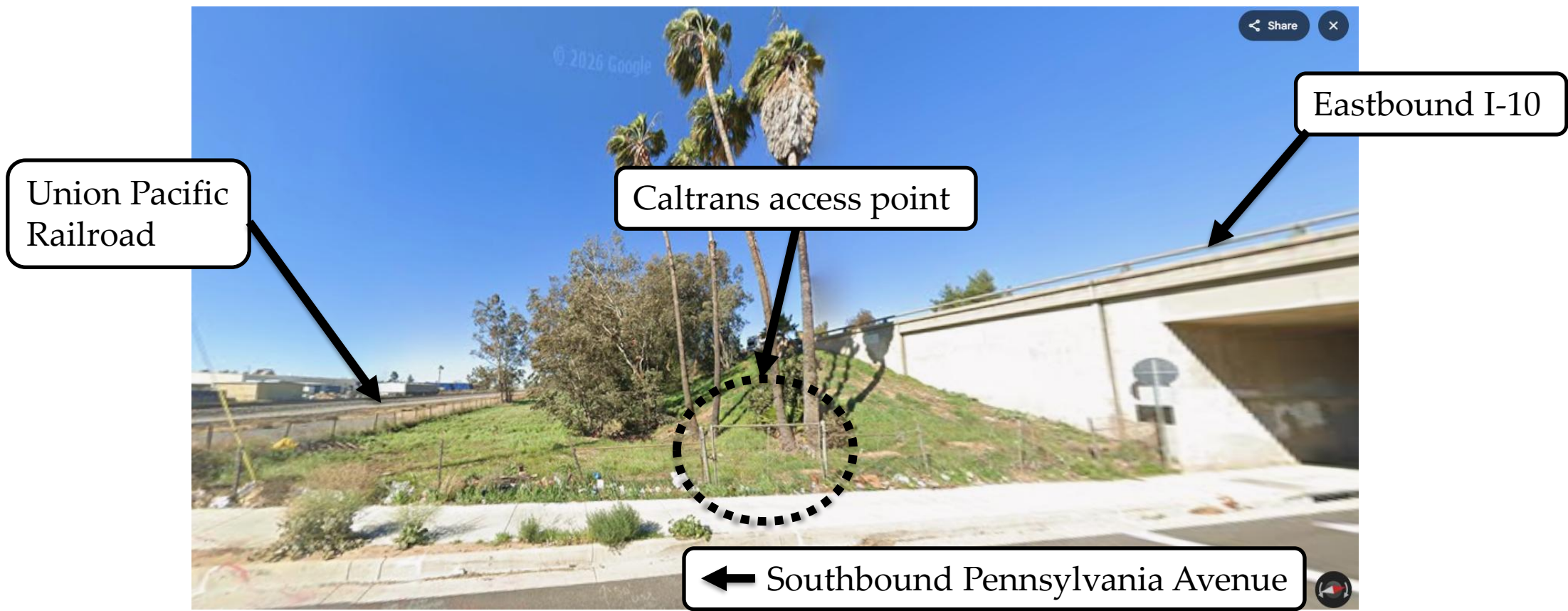


Image is looking west

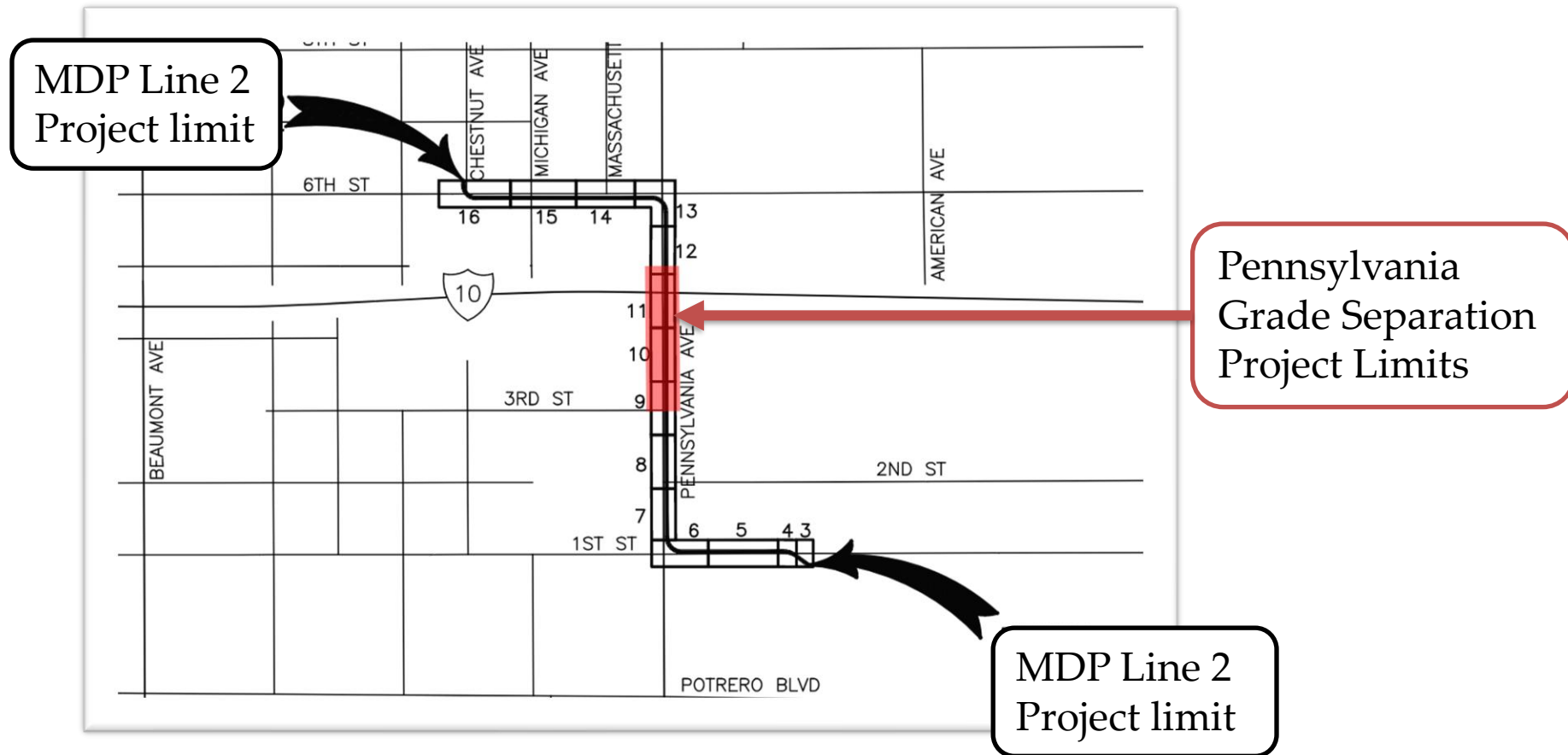
Union Pacific Railroad

- Construction & Maintenance agreement
 - Engage at 100% Design
 - Months-long negotiations
 - Agreement execution required to advertise construction

MDP Line 2 – Purpose

- Future stormwater flows
 - 5,000 LF of pipe
 - 25 - 43 ft. below existing
- Must go in before grade separation
 - Runoff would cause ponding/flooding
 - Essential for roadway and pedestrian safety

MDP Line 2 - Limits



Cost Increases

- Construction estimate: \$128.6 million
 - Updated May 2026
 - In November 2024: \$74.5 million
- Funding gap: \$47.7 million
- 65% Design yields:
 - Refined quantities
 - Identified utility relocations and right-of-way needs
 - Updated labor, steel, concrete and construction pricing
 - Increased construction management and railroad coordination costs

Funding Deadlines

- \$49 million Trade Corridor Enhancement Program (TCEP) & \$6.7 million State Transportation Improvement Program (STIP)
 - Construction-ready: April 2027 for June TCEP allocation

TCEP Fund Requirement

- Ready-to-list by April 2027, ahead of the June 2027 CTC meeting
- Construction award – 6 months after allocation – December 2027

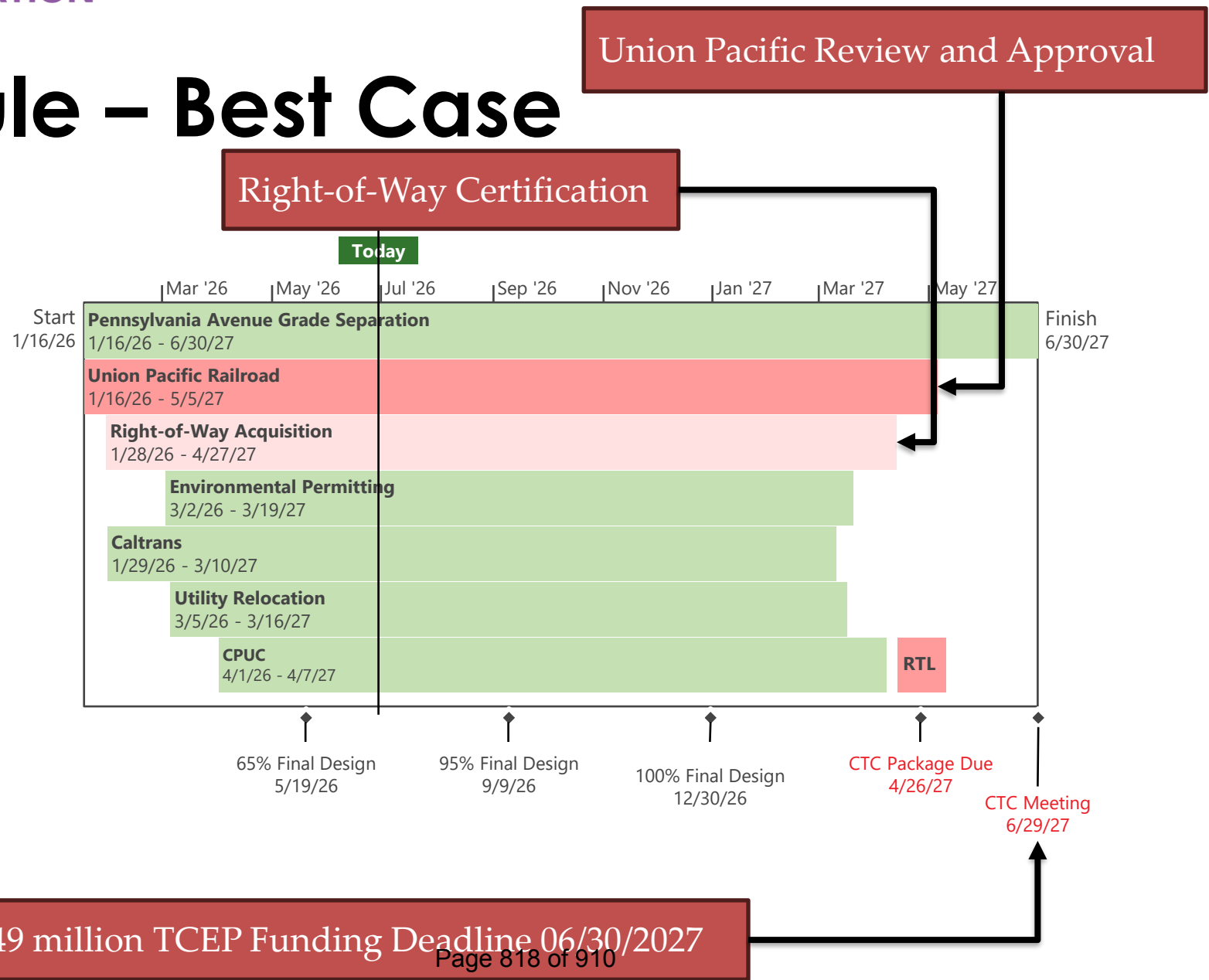
Project Status

- Caltrans 95% Final Design: September 2026
- UPRR 60% Second Resubmittal: July 2026
- UPRR declined accelerated review and early C&M Agreement development
- Typical UPRR timeline:
 - 6-week review period
 - 4-month C&M Agreement development after final design approval





Schedule – Best Case

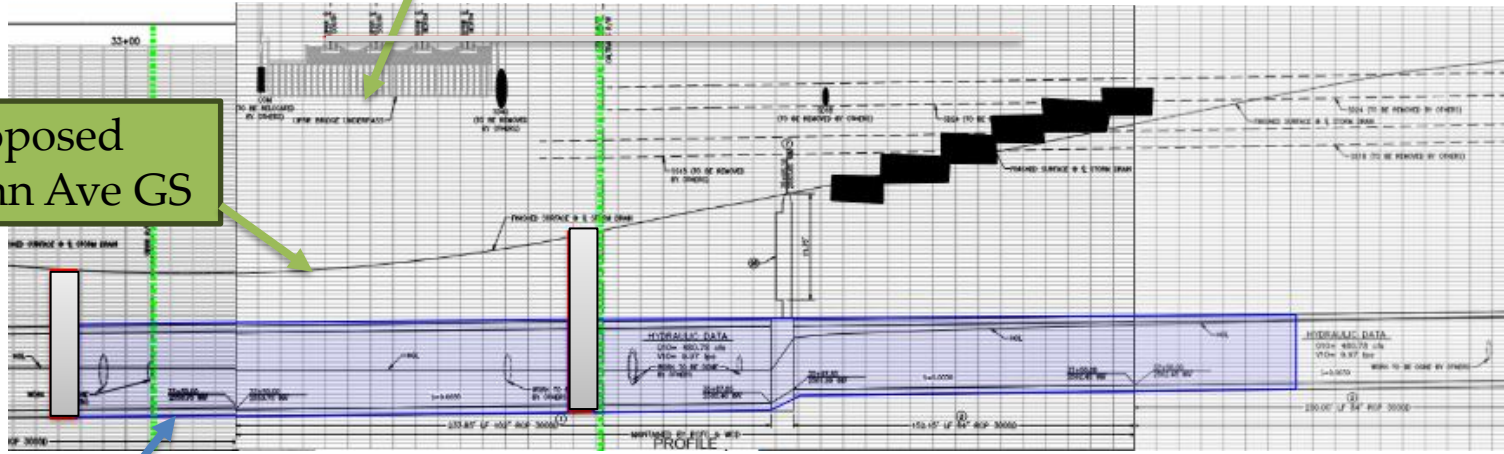




Ex. I-10 Bridge

Proposed Union Pacific Railroad Bridge

Proposed
Penn Ave GS



102" Dia. Pipe

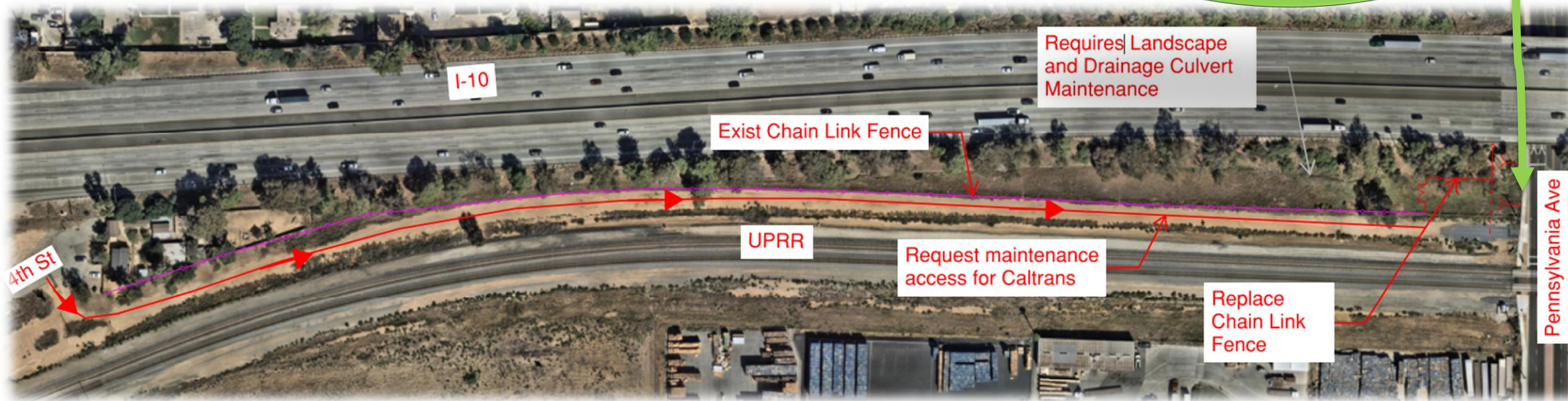
Pennsylvania Ave

UPRR

I-10

Master Drainage Plan (MDP) – Line 2

Caltrans Maintenance Access Through UPRR R/W





Potential Schedule Risks

Penn Ave GS Project

Union Pacific
Design Review and Approval
C&M Agreement

UPRR rejected the request for over-the-shoulder reviews; standard review process applies.
UPRR will start C&M Agreement development only at 100%; request to start earlier was rejected.

Third-Party Utility Relocation
SCE – Water – Sewer – Verizon/MCI

Notice to Relocate issued. Potential delays in relocations may impact RTL and construction award. Potential SCE UG Relocation due to access requirement; cost and time impacts (3-6 months SCE design delay)

Right-of-Way Acquisition – Private Properties, Caltrans Access Eliminated by Retaining Wallas

ROW started early discussions and is issuing offers; acceptance is pending. New issue: Caltrans post-project access must be provided. Potential options if UPRR agrees with parallel access, coordination required with FHWA for modifying access control (3-6 months).

Environmental Permitting – Lack of Independent Utility; Grade Separation Dependent on MDP Line 2 Project

Resource agency permit approvals may be contingent on completing MDP Line 2 before the Grade Separation Project. Potential 12- to 18-month delay to RTL.

MDP Line 2 Project Delay (During Design or Construction Phases)

Any delay will impact the project. Construction award is required within 6 months after RTL; this date cannot be missed.

Caltrans Approval (e.g. Ramp Metering Exception)

HDR team to submit design exception ASAP. Exception to be approved by HQ, not District.

Funding Gap

Based on 65% design, project is \$47.7 million short of funding

Potential Schedule Risks

Master Drainage Plan (MDP) Line 2

Third-Party Utility Relocation
Water – 30-inch gas line

Potential 12- to 18-month delay to construction award

Caltrans Approval: Potential Delay Due to Deviation Approval for Pipe Installation Adjacent to I-10 Bridge Foundation (<15 ft).

Schedule: 7/1/26 – 10/6/26
Delay in finalizing the design package impacts ability to include with the grade separation construction bid package
20-day review period for Caltrans

UPRR License Agreement: Potential Delay Associated with UPRR License Agreement for MDP Line 2 Crossing.

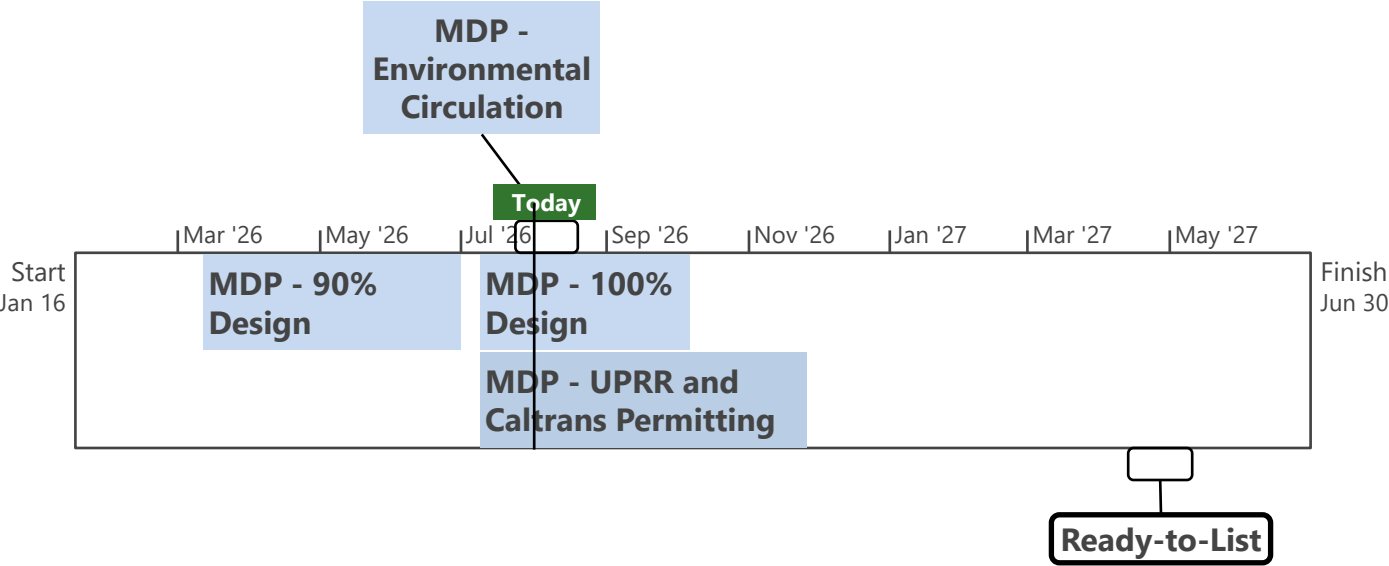
Schedule: 7/30/26 – 11/25/26
If this does not occur, it will delay finalization of the bid package and advertisement of the joint project

Potential Funding Gap – Current Funding: \$9 million

Contingency Plan?



MDP Line 2 – Schedule



Recommendation

Return TCEP funding to CTC and reapply for future cycle.

- Allow project to secure additional funding to cover the grade separation shortfall.
- Mitigates potential UPRR delays
- Allows design team to address all design challenges
- Separate the storm drain project from the grade separation project
 - Allow storm drain construction to proceed prior to the grade separation.
 - Complete drainage infrastructure needed within the project footprint and outfall area.
 - Reduces risk to grade separation construction advertisement and award dates.



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